

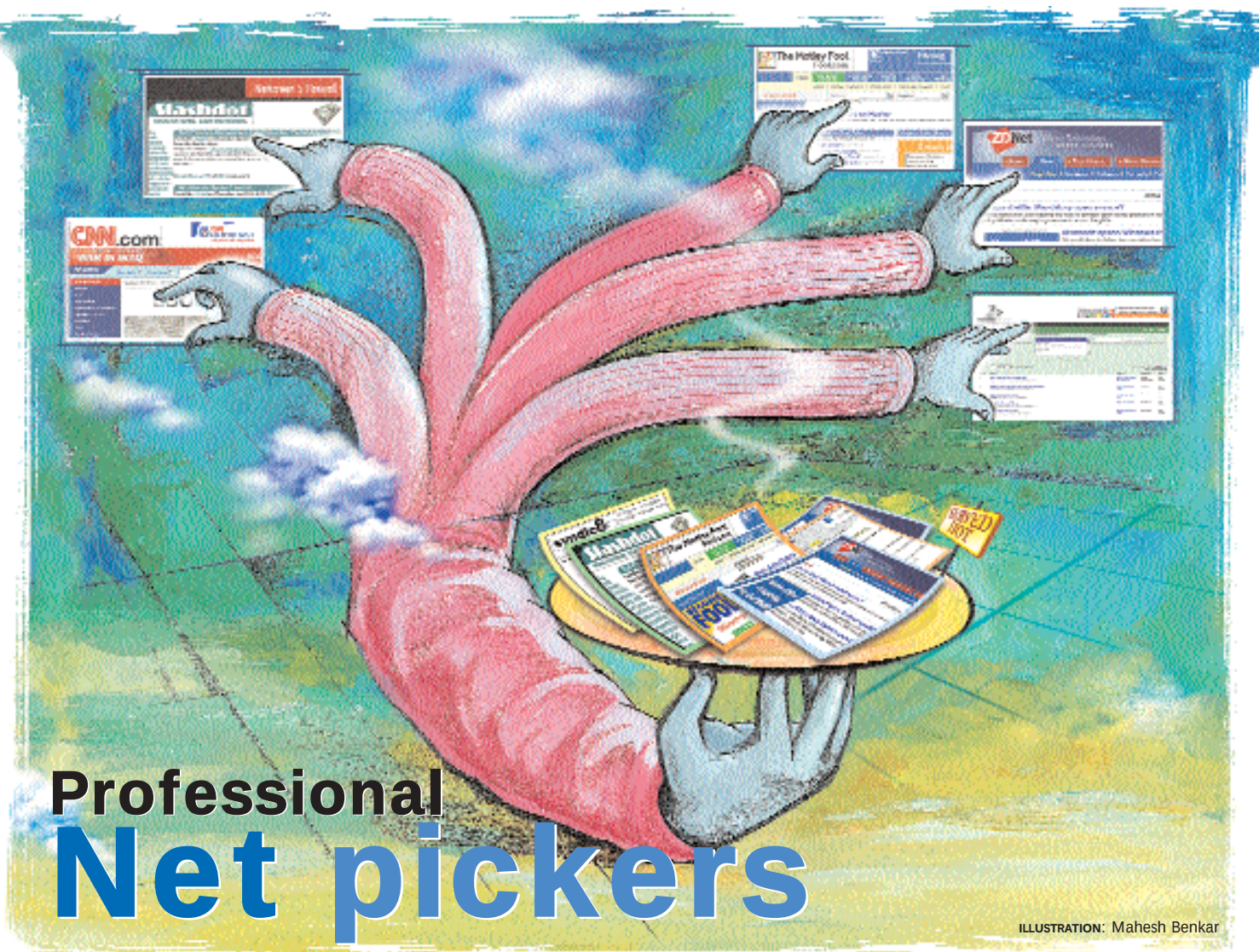


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Professional Net pickers

The Internet connects you to information, but can you use it to bring information to you? Here's how to get relevant news and information delivered to your desktop

The amount of information that's available on the Net is staggering. The most common way of sifting through it all is to use search engines such as Google or Lycos, and browse through the results to find the most relevant links. When you find pages that you would like to visit again or keep track of, you can bookmark them by adding them to your Favourites. Now, this involves a lot of work, as sometimes the Favourites list can contain more than a hundred different

Web sites. Getting the latest from all these sites, involves a lot of patience, as graphics and large sized pages take some time to load. Often you have to wait for entire pages to load and search through immense amounts of uninteresting text to find what you need.

Now, imagine a technology that helps you obtain updated information, on any subject of your choice, without any effort on your part—except for a double-click here or a right-click there. Sounds interesting, doesn't it? This kind of a tool called aggregation or syndication that gathers the latest information to bring it to you has been around for some time now.

What is aggregation?

Aggregation or syndication is a simple concept, where data in an XML (eXtensible

Markup Language) format document standard called RSS (Rich Site Summary), is collated and displayed. RSS is widely available today and enables the sharing of resources and news, easily and quickly.

Web sites such as Google news and Yahoo! News, use their own aggregators to crawl the Web and mine the latest news from around the world. While these news sites are very reliable, you wouldn't find anything here that a regular Web search couldn't yield—and you will still have to do a lot of sifting to get to the most relevant bits. In addition, you will have to scan through pages upon pages of headlines—a list of practically everything that has happened around the world—to find the things that are of interest to you.

Of course, not all of us are general news buffs. Some of us prefer to get the

Amphetadest v0.93.1, Syndirella 0.9b and Microsoft .NET Framework v1.1.
Find it on the Mindware CD

